

8. Scale-out and shared-core are two of the keywords you are bound to encounter when reading about HCI. Basically, most HCI implementations involve multiple servers or nodes in a cluster, with the storage resources distributed across the nodes. This provides resilience against any component or node failure. Plus, by placing storage at the nodes, the data is closer to compute than a traditional storage area network. So, you can actually get the most out of faster storage technologies like non-volatile memory express (NVMe) or non-volatile dual in-line memory module (NVDIMM).

The scale-out architecture also enables a company to add nodes as and when required rather than investing in everything upfront. Just add a node and connect it to the network, and you are ready to go. The resources are automatically rebalanced and ready to use.

A lot of hyper-converged implementations also have a shared core, that is, the storage and virtual machines compete for the same processors and memory. This reduces wastage and optimises resource usage. However, some experts feel that in some special cases, users might have to buy more equipment to run the same workloads.

9. It's true that HCI is great for small enterprises as it can be used without fuss and hassles, but it can be used by really large data centres too. Leading companies have on record hyper-convergence case studies where more than a thousand HCI nodes are installed in a single data centre.

10. In a recent survey, research leader Forrester found that the most common workloads being run on hyper-converged systems are: database, such as Oracle or SQL server (cited by 50 per cent); file and print services (40 per cent); collaboration, such as Exchange or SharePoint (38 per cent); virtual desktop (34 per cent); commercial packaged software such as SAP and Oracle (33 per cent); analytics (25 per cent); and Web-facing workloads such as LAMP stack or web servers (17 per cent).

11. During a recent talk, Dell EMC European chief technology officer for converged and hyper-converged infrastructure, Nigel Moulton, said that "mission-critical applications live best in converged infrastructures." He justified his view by saying that many mission-critical applications such as ERP are architected to rely on the underlying hardware (in the storage area network) for encryption, replication and high availability. In HCI on the other hand, many of these things come from the software stack. Instead of looking at the move to HCI as all-or-none, he suggested that organisations take a practical look at it. If an application can work on HCI, companies must make the move as and when their existing hardware reaches end of life. The rest can remain on traditional hardware or converged

Some leading players

- Nutanix
- HPE's Simplivity
- Cisco Systems
- NetApp
- Dell EMC and VMware
- Pivot3

companies must make the move as and when their existing hardware reaches end of life. The rest can remain on traditional hardware or converged

Replace

High Mast Metal Halide / Sodium Lights

with

Binyay PowerLED

HIGH MAST LIGHTS

With Binyay DRIVER-LESS DC Bus Technology

and save more than over

70%

POWER

5 YEARS warranty

DRIVER-LESS Operation with BINAY DC Bus Technology

High Reliability with "Ground-Level" Maintenance Convenience

Replaces 400W/800W Metal Halide

Reliable Operation even at High Ambient Temperatures

IP65 rated

ON Time less than 0.5 seconds

High Lumen Maintenance over lifetime

Binyay Opto Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
 27, PANDITIA TERRACE, Calcutta 700 029, India
 Telephone: +91 (33) 4006 9875, 2475 0392, 2475 0030
 email: info@binyayled.com, http://www.binyayled.com

POWERING LED TECHNOLOGIES WORLDWIDE SINCE 1983